

KENNETH GONZALEZ PICADO

Operations Architect | AI-Augmented Systems Designer | Organizational Transformation

San José, Costa Rica · picado80@hotmail.com · Remote-first · Available 5:00 AM – 7:00 PM CT (US, LATAM, Early EU)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations leader with 14+ years scaling Amazon's customer service operating model across LATAM and 1.5+ years architecting full-stack transformation programs as co-founder of Cawhi Consultores. Led teams of 15 direct and 150 indirect reports, managed a \$500K operational budget, and owned a quality audit framework spanning 4 countries (Mexico, Costa Rica, Colombia, Brazil). Specialized in deploying AI-augmented operational infrastructure—policy portals, multi-layer audit systems, performance evaluation platforms, and continuous improvement loops—that traditionally require multi-disciplinary teams of 3–5 specialists. Self-taught builder with hands-on command of LLM-driven workflows, prompt engineering, instructional design, and process automation. Bilingual (Spanish/English), comfortable leading cross-functional teams across LATAM and remote-first environments.

SIGNATURE METRICS

- ▶ **\$500K** operational budget ownership at Amazon
- ▶ **165 people** led at peak (15 direct + 150 indirect) across multiple LATAM sites
- ▶ **4 countries** (Mexico, Costa Rica, Colombia, Brazil) operating under audit framework I designed and governed
- ▶ **350+** structured behavioral interviews (Amazon Bar Raiser methodology)
- ▶ **100+** interns recruited and onboarded via Tech Scholars program (85%+ advancement rate)
- ▶ **60%** reduction in manager ramp-up time during Amazon's hyper-growth phase
- ▶ **50%+** of internal manager promotions sourced from leadership pipeline I designed
- ▶ **60%** diagnostic-to-retainer conversion rate at Cawhi Consultores

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operations Strategy: Process Architecture, Workflow Design, SOP Documentation, Operational Excellence Frameworks, Change Management, Continuous Improvement (Kaizen, WBR), Cross-Functional Leadership

Organizational Development: Organizational Climate Diagnostics, Employee Engagement, Performance Management Systems, 9-Box Talent Grids, Succession Planning, Leadership Coaching, Career Pathing

AI & Automation: LLM Workflow Design, Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Process Mapping, Generative Content Systems, Custom GPT/Claude Integrations, Document Automation, AI-Augmented Audit & Reporting

Training & Enablement: Instructional Design, Curriculum Architecture, Onboarding Programs, Multi-Phase Evaluation Systems, Coaching Frameworks, Train-the-Trainer Programs

Performance & Metrics: KPI Framework Design, Balanced Scorecards, OKRs, Quality Audit Systems, Dashboard Design, Business Reviews (WBR/MBR), Compliance Frameworks

Tooling: Claude (Anthropic), ChatGPT, Gemini, Gamma, Canva, Notion, Asana, Miro, Lucidchart, Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Slack, ODOO, HighLevel, Higgsfield, ElevenLabs, HeyGen, Loom

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cawhi Consultores — San José, Costa Rica

Co-Founder & Operations Architect | October 2024 – Present

- **Built end-to-end operational excellence system** for hospitality client operating at 25% capacity (200 of 800 daily): designed five-layer continuous improvement architecture (policies → metrics → audits → dashboards → weekly business

reviews), deployed an internal Google Sites policy portal, 15+ digital audit forms, and 6 leader-owned dashboards; system replaces what would conventionally require an internal Operations Manager + Quality Lead + L&D Lead.

- **Architected performance evaluation platform** for credit cooperative (1,000+ employees) using a 70/30 hybrid model (Oracle KPI integration + 9-box human evaluation across values & potential), with automated tier-based action triggers (Succession Planning, Skill-Building, PIP); sold and structured the engagement with executive leadership through interactive mockup before development.
- **Designed and delivered multi-phase staff onboarding system** (4-week structured training + 6-week fit evaluation across 18 service zones) with weighted scoring rubrics, knowledge quizzes, and quantitative cultural-fit measurement, replacing ad-hoc onboarding for a 60+ person operation.
- **Led organizational climate diagnostics** for 5 clients across hospitality, financial services, manufacturing, and printing/graphic industries within first 12 months, converting 60% of diagnostic engagements into 6-month retainer contracts.
- **Integrated AI tools natively into consulting delivery** (Claude, custom GPTs, Gamma, Higgsfield) for process mapping, interview synthesis, policy drafting, audit automation, and content production—reducing typical consulting delivery time by an estimated 50–70% per engagement.
- **Designed leadership coaching programs** with structured session arcs, accountability tracking, and asynchronous check-ins for emerging leaders in client organizations; delivered measurable behavioral change in 6–8 week cycles.
- **Built productized service catalog** with four-tier business model (SaaS subscription tiers + transformation consulting tier) including pricing architecture, sales funnels, and distributed facilitator network across LATAM.

Amazon — San José & Heredia, Costa Rica

Customer Service Manager & Leadership Development Lead | July 2010 – April 2024 (14 years)

- **Operational Leadership at Scale:** Led 15 direct reports and 150 indirect reports across multiple LATAM sites, owning a \$500K operational budget; consistently met or exceeded SLAs for service excellence, employee retention, and operational efficiency in a 24/7 environment.
- **Multi-Country Quality Audit Framework Owner:** Led design, rollout, and governance of payroll quality audit framework spanning 4 countries (Mexico, Costa Rica, Colombia, Brazil); trained 20+ regional teams on audit protocols, achieving 35% improvement in user-experience metrics and material reduction in payroll-related errors and escalations.
- **Manager Development Pipeline (Pre- and During-COVID Hyper-Growth):** Designed and delivered comprehensive leadership development curriculum that generated 50%+ of internal manager promotions and reduced manager ramp-up time by 60% during exponential growth phase; trained pipelines that scaled from dozens to hundreds of associates.
- **Strategic Recruitment & Talent Acquisition:** Conducted 350+ structured behavioral interviews (Amazon Bar Raiser methodology) for internal and external manager candidates; established and scaled the Tech Scholars program, recruiting and onboarding 100+ interns from technical institutions with 85%+ advancement rate to full-time roles.
- **Internal Mobility & Career Development:** Launched 2 internal career fairs with 800+ participants, increasing internal mobility, reducing external hiring costs, and strengthening employee retention; designed individualized talent development roadmaps for 45+ direct reports.
- **Quality Analyst & QA Manager — Payroll Operations (Dec 2021 – Jul 2024):** Developed and implemented quality assurance frameworks for payroll systems and processes ensuring compliance and accuracy across LATAM; mentored junior analysts and trained cross-functional teams on QA best practices and audit methodologies.

SELECTED ENGAGEMENTS & SYSTEMS BUILT

Hospitality — Operational Excellence Infrastructure (Anfiteatro de Villa). Designed full-stack operating system for an 800-capacity event venue: 6 leader-owned domains, 15+ digital audit forms, internal policy portal, 4-week onboarding + 6-week fit evaluation, formal audit guide documents, and weekly business review cadence. Replaced informal management with a measurable, accountability-driven structure.

Financial Services — Performance Evaluation Platform (COOPENAE, 1,000+ employees). Architected and sold (via interactive mockup) a 70/30 evaluation system combining Oracle HRIS KPIs with 9-box talent grids; defined performance

tiers and automated action triggers (Succession Planning, Skill-Building, PIP); structured a 3-phase implementation roadmap with technical handoff to engineering.

Graphic Industry — Sales Transformation Campaign (ASOINGRAF). Built complete masterclass-to-paid-workshop funnel ("Selling in Times of Change") for the country's graphic industry trade association: positioning strategy, multi-platform copy (Instagram/Facebook/LinkedIn/TikTok), Canva/Gamma deliverables, scripts for facilitator, and 18-day execution calendar.

Healthcare Events — Sponsorship & Prospecting Architecture (Medical Summit Costa Rica 2026). Designed three-tier sponsorship product (Oro/Plata/Bronze + Demo Partner), structured sponsorship pitch documents tailored to pharma, medtech, and luxury verticals, and built prospecting database for 200-attendee professional event.

Logistics — Subscription Training Model (Rayo Mensajería). Productized leadership training as a recurring monthly subscription, replacing one-off consulting with predictable revenue and continuous capability development.

AI & TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

LLM-Native Workflows: Daily operational use of Claude (Anthropic) and GPT for process mapping, policy drafting, audit synthesis, interview analysis, content systems, instructional design, and stakeholder communication. Comfortable designing structured prompts, long-context workflows, multi-step agentic tasks, and prompt-template libraries for non-technical teams.

AI-Augmented Service Delivery: Embedded AI as a force multiplier in consulting engagements—replacing what would normally require copywriters, instructional designers, junior analysts, and QA reviewers with structured AI workflows operated by a small core team.

Platforms & Tools: Claude, Claude Code, Cowork, ChatGPT, Custom GPTs, Gemini, Gamma, Canva, Higgsfield, Runway, ElevenLabs, HeyGen, Loom, Notion, Asana, Miro, Lucidchart, Google Sites, Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Slack, ODOO, HighLevel, Zapier (concept-level), CRM systems.

Self-Taught Builder Discipline: Continuously study and ship in operations, AI integration, instructional design, organizational psychology, and product strategy. Capable of independently designing and operating systems that traditionally require formal credentials in HR, OD, and Quality.

EDUCATION & CONTINUOUS DEVELOPMENT

- Digital Marketing & Leadership Development — NextU
- Professional Development — Stratford Career Institute
- Amazon Leadership Principles & Bar Raiser Interview Methodology (internal certifications)
- Self-directed study: AI/LLM systems, prompt engineering, organizational design, instructional design, performance management

LANGUAGES & AVAILABILITY

Languages: Spanish (native) · English (professional fluency — read, write, speak)

Availability: Full-time, fractional, or part-time engagements · 100% remote preferred · 5:00 AM – 7:00 PM Central Time (overlaps with US, LATAM, and early Europe time zones)

Engagement Models: Operations Architect / Head of Ops, Fractional COO, Director of Transformation / Org. Development, Senior / Principal Consultant